

HAULING STONE

Huge blocks of stone for Pharaoh Khafre's new pyramid have arrived from the harbor. Teams of men place them on sleds for hauling to the pyramid. The heaviest stones aren't just dragged—a series of wooden rollers are placed under them. New rollers are added in front of the sled as the team pulls it along.

Plumb bob

The pyramids were built accurately using simple tools made of wood, string, and stone. This is a plumb bob. It was hung from a string on a wooden A-frame to make a level. When the string aligned with the center of the A-frame's crosspiece, the surface it sat on was level.



This man is trying to direct the hauling teams so they don't crash into each other.

Stonemasons' tools

Limestone was smoothed using copper chisels. The stonemason held a chisel in one hand and pounded it with a wooden mallet. Workmen had to stop and resharpen their tools often, so there were full-time tool sharpeners on hand to support them.

Mallet

Basket



Chisel



Stone masons shape the blocks, making sure they are smooth.

Wooden sleds are used to move the huge stone blocks.

"The mouth of a perfectly contented man is filled with beer."

—Egyptian proverb, c. 2200 BCE

